

A detailed close-up photograph of a vintage aircraft's engine and wing. The engine, located on the left, features a prominent radial cooling fan with many thin, dark blades. Various metal pipes, bolts, and structural components are visible, showing the intricate engineering of the era. The wing, which is the primary focus, extends from the engine towards the right. It has a smooth, light-colored surface, possibly painted or polished metal, and is reinforced with a series of small, evenly spaced rivets along its leading edge and other structural joints. The lighting is bright, highlighting the textures and metallic sheen of the aircraft parts.

# The 1920s

Spectacular air shows and itinerant barnstormers drew huge crowds during the 1920s, with daredevils walking on aircraft wings and performing other outrageous aerobatic feats. By the end of the decade new streamlined all-metal single-seater monoplanes that traveled faster than ever before began to compete for speed prizes. Aviation captured the attention of a worldwide audience in 1927, when Charles Lindbergh made the first solo crossing of the Atlantic in the specially built single-engined monoplane *Spirit of St. Louis*.